

AY25 PROGRAM ASSESSMENT REPORT

v2026.1

Tracking data

CIM code (e.g., ME-CM)	PHD-IOPS
Program Name	PhD in Industrial-Organizational Psychology
Assessment Year	AY 2024-2025
Program Assessment Coordinator	Kristina Bauer
Year of Current Assessment Plan	Fall 2016
No Assessment This Year per Plan	X
LO(s) Assessed	1. Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge in the three key areas of I/O psychology – personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics. 2. Communicate (orally and written) research results to a scientific audience. 3. Perform quality, independent research that contributes to the field of I/O psychology. 4. Apply I/O knowledge (i.e., personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics) to a work setting.
Presented at program authority meeting date:	10/15/2025
<i>Please attach minutes</i>	See Appendix A

Methodology

The rubrics for each artifact are provided in Appendix B.

1. Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge in the three key areas of I/O psychology – personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics.
 - a. PhD Comprehensive Exams are given at the end of each semester as long as a student indicates they are ready to take the exam. There are three separate exams given during a 1-week span, one for each of the key areas in I/O psychology (i.e., personnel, organizational, and research methods/statistics). Students answer four out of six of the questions on each exam during a 4-hour time block. Questions are written to tap a breadth of knowledge across the three key areas. By breadth, we mean that items tap as many of the competencies identified by the Society for Industrial and Organizational Psychology's (SIOP, 2016) *guidelines for education and training in I/O psychology* as possible. The competencies are provided in Appendix C. Note that the competencies are directly from SIOP, and therefore not structured into the three key areas.
 - b. Comprehensive exams are graded each semester and trends are evaluated every four academic years. Each answer on each exam is rated on a 7-point scale (see Appendix B)

by at least two of the I/O faculty members who have expertise in the area of the question. Raters discuss discrepancies but are not required to come to a consensus. The program averages the scores across the four items, resulting in an average rating on each exam. The average determines the student's assessment category.

- c. Assessment Categories:
 - i. Does not meet expectations: average rating < 3.50
 - ii. Meets expectations, but some weak areas: average rating 3.50-3.99
 - iii. Fully meets expectations: average rating ≥ 4.00
2. Communicate (orally and written) research results to a scientific audience.
 - a. Artifact 1: Thesis, Thesis-equivalence, and Dissertation defense – utilizes the Assessment Rubric for Thesis and Dissertation Defenses (Written and Oral Communication).
 - i. After each thesis and dissertation defense, committee members rate the student using the rubric. Thesis and dissertation committees vary by student, but are always chaired by an I/O faculty member. Thesis committees are comprised of three psychology faculty. Dissertation committees are comprised of three psychology faculty members and one faculty member from Illinois Tech outside the department.
 - ii. Assessment Categories:
 1. Does not meet expectations: Students who receive a rating < 2 on either dimension.
 2. Meets expectations: Students who receive an average rating < 3.0 with at least a 2 rating on each dimension.
 3. Exceeds expectations: Students who receive a 3 rating of three on both dimensions.
 - b. Artifact 2: Number of student publications and presentations.
 - i. The annual I/O program newsletter includes APA citations of all publications and presentations from the previous academic year. Student authors are denoted with an asterisk. In the Fall before the next full assessment of results, one I/O faculty member will compile the information on publications and presentations and all I/O faculty members will review and discuss the results. It should also be noted that both conference presentations and publications are peer reviewed by external reviewers.
 - ii. Assessment Categories
 1. Exceeds expectations: $> 80\%$ of PhD students with a publication or presentation each year
 2. Meets expectations: 50%-80% of PhD students with a publication or presentation each year
 3. Below expectations: $< 50\%$ of PhD students with a publication or presentation each year
3. Perform quality, independent research that contributes to the field of I/O psychology.
 - a. Artifact: Thesis, Thesis-equivalence, and Dissertation defense – utilizes the Assessment Rubric for Thesis and Dissertation Defenses (Ability to Design and Perform Quality Research).
 - b. After each thesis and dissertation defense, committee members rate the student using the rubric. Thesis and dissertation committees vary by student, but are always chaired

by an I/O faculty member. Thesis committees are comprised of three psychology faculty. Dissertation committees are comprised of three psychology faculty members and one faculty member from Illinois Tech outside the department.

- c. Assessment Categories:
 - i. Does not meet expectations: Students who receive a rating <2 on either dimension.
 - ii. Meets expectations: Students who receive an average rating <3.0 with at least a 2 rating on each dimension.
 - iii. Exceeds expectations: Students who receive a 3 rating of three on both dimensions.
4. Apply I/O knowledge (i.e., personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics) to a work setting.
- a. Artifact: Internship supervisor evaluations—When students complete an internship, they enroll in at least three credits of PSYC 558. Roya Ayman is the instructor of record for the course each semester. Internships are 3-month, half time positions in I/O or HR at a variety of companies.
 - b. At the end of the internship, the student's internship supervisor completes the Internship Evaluation Form.
 - c. The assessment categories are:
 - i. Does not meet expectations: Students who receive a rating <3 on any item.
 - ii. Meets expectations: Students who receive an average rating <4.0 with at least a 3 rating on each item.
 - iii. Exceeds expectations: Students who receive an average rating ≥ 4.0 with at least a 3 rating on each item.

Results

Artifact samples

N/A

Data table

Learning Outcome 1

Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge in the three key areas of I/O psychology – personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics.

Category	Organizational Psychology Exam		Personnel Psychology Exam		Research Methods & Statistics Exam	
	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%
Does not meet expectations (D)	3	60%	2	40%	4	67%
Meets expectations, but some weak areas (MW)	2	40%	1	20%	1	17%
Meets expectations (M)	0	0%	2	40%	1	17%

Learning Outcome 2a

Communicate (orally and written) research results to a scientific audience.

Category	Oral Communication - MS		Oral Communication - PhD		Written Communication - MS		Written Communication - PhD	
	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%
Does not meet expectations (D)	1	25%	1	33%	0	0%	0	0%
Meets expectations (M)	1	25%	1	33%	4	100%	2	67%
Exceeds expectations (E)	2	50%	1	33%	0	0%	1	33%

Learning Outcome 2b

Communicate (orally and written) research results to a scientific audience.

In the Fall before the next full assessment of results due Fall 2027, one I/O faculty member will compile the information on publications and presentations for review.

Learning Outcome 3

Perform quality, independent research that contributes to the field of I/O psychology.

	Design and Perform Research - MS		Design and Perform Research - PhD	
Category	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%
Does not meet expectations (D)	0	0%	0	0%
Meets expectations (M)	2	50%	1	33%
Exceeds expectations (E)	2	50%	2	67%

Learning Outcome 4

Apply I/O knowledge (i.e., personnel psychology, organizational psychology, and research methods and statistics) to a work setting.

Category	<i>N</i>	%
Does not meet expectations (D)	1	11%
Meets expectations (M)	1	11%
Exceeds expectations (E)	7	78%

Description of findings

The I/O program only analyzes data every four academic years to ensure a sufficient sample size. An evaluation and full discussion of the results is planned for the Assessment Report due Fall 2027. However, the IO faculty briefly reviewed the data and see no issues.

Continuous Improvement, CI, plans

The purpose of assessment is to improve the quality of our educational programs. The most important part of the assessment cycle is how we use the data to improve our programs. Examine the data provided above describing student achievement, and if areas for possible improvement emerge, describe plans to achieve this improvement.

Prior CI plan impact

In the 2022-2023 report, the IO faculty noted some issues with the way students answered questions on the research methods/statistics comprehensive exam and proposed an ongoing review of the curriculum to determine where the content is covered. Discussion of the coverage of research methods and statistics, as well as strategies to ensure adequate coverage continues.

In the 2023-2024 report, the IO faculty noted that the Society for Industrial and Organizational Psychology (SIOP) had formed a committee to revise the Graduate Education and Training Guidelines. We monitored the committee's work; however, only draft Guidelines have been released for a review and commentary period prior to submission to APA. The currently available draft shows slightly modernized competencies, but no major changes. This should position the program to only potentially need to make minor adjustments once finalized.

This cycle's CI plan

The IO program plans to continue monitoring coverage of research methods/statistics in courses and students' comprehensive exam answers. We will also continue to monitor SIOP's communications about the revisions to the Graduate Education and Training Guidelines and will adjust accordingly when they are officially released.

Appendix A

IO Program Meeting Minutes

Present: Scott Morris (Program Director), Roya Ayman, Kristina Bauer, Rob Keating

- Briefly reviewed metrics before moving to the single year data. The IO program reviewed the tables and agreed that based on one limited one year of data there's no area of concern.
- One student had lower than expected performance on their internship. Faculty discussed potential reasons, including a potential formula error. It was in fact a formula error (i.e., it was reading a blank cell as < 3); the data have been updated.
- Reviewed previous CI plans and agreed to continue with them.

Appendix B

Rubrics Described in this Report

PhD Comprehensive Exam Rating Scale

- 7 Exceptional. Demonstrates unique insights into topic.
- 6 Very Good. All aspects of "5", but even more so.
- 5 Slightly Above Minimum Passing. Multiple correct citations. Integration of topics. Presents a convincing logical argument.
4. Minimum Passing. Demonstrates basic understanding of topic, and adequately answers the question. All major issues are discussed. Terms are correctly defined. Critical citations given. Answer is presented in a coherent order.
- 3 Slightly Below Minimum Passing. Fails to adequately or correctly explain all aspect of the topic/question.
- 2 Poor. Demonstrates a serious misunderstanding of topic, or fails to address a critical component of the question.
- 1 Totally Inadequate.

PhD Comprehensive Exam Rubric

Assessment Category	Description	Rating
Fully Meets Expectations	• Demonstrates a comprehensive knowledge of the concepts and literature in the areas of organizational psychology, personnel psychology, statistics and psychometrics. • Integrates information from multiple topics or theories to address specific questions	≥ 4.00
Meets Expectations, But Some Weak Areas	• Demonstrates knowledge of key concepts and literature in the areas of organizational psychology, personnel psychology, statistics and psychometrics. • Describes some concepts or areas of literature with inadequate depth • Commits minor errors, but demonstrates understanding of key concepts • Limited integration or application of topics to address specific questions	3.50-3.99
Does Not Meet Expectations	• Presents inaccurate or incomplete description of key concepts or literature across multiple topics	<3.50

Assessment Rubric for Thesis and Dissertation Defenses

	Oral Communication			Rating
	1 – Below Expectations	2 – Meets Expectations	3 – Exceeds Expectations	
Mechanics	Structure unclear; Main points unclear; Uninteresting slides; Hard to read/understand; Numerous errors	Satisfactory structure and organization; Main points well stated; Transitions may be unclear; Satisfactory slides; Easy to read; Few errors	Superb structure and organization; Main points well stated; Arguments easy to follow; Engaging slides; Greatly assist in message delivery; No errors	
Delivery	Cannot be understood; Awkward gestures/body language; Minimal eye contact with audience; Not able to answer committee questions without help from Chair	Clear voice; Few distracting gestures; Good eye contact; Competently answer questions and committee members' comments with some help from Chair	Confident delivery; Enhances the message through inflection, volume, pace; Engaging interaction with committee members; Answers questions independently and confidently with no help from Chair	

	Written Communication			Rating
	1 – Below Expectations	2 – Meets Expectations	3 – Exceeds Expectations	
Style	Numerous grammatical/ spelling errors; Numerous run-on sentences or fragments; Not in APA format; Tables & figures are incomplete, incorrect or hard to understand	Relatively few grammatical/ spelling errors; APA formatting is followed; Tables & figures are accurate and easy to read	Almost no grammatical/ spelling errors; Arguments easy to follow. Tables & figures facilitation interpretation	
Organization	Text rambles and structure is hard to follow; Main ideas and logic cannot be determined	Material is presented following a clear structure; Main ideas are clear, but transitions between ideas may be lacking	Material is structured to facilitate easy comprehension; Transitions facilitate the development of a story	
Articulation of Research Questions	Relevance of research questions unclear; Theoretical basis of hypotheses is poorly developed	Relevance of research questions clearly stated; Hypotheses are clear and justified by theory	Unique research question that substantially advances the literature; Hypotheses are a model of clarity	

	Ability to Design and Perform Quality Research			Rating
	1 – Below Expectations	2 – Meets Expectations	3 – Exceeds Expectations	
Research Design & Operationalization	Design is insufficient to address the research question/hypotheses; Insufficient power; Inadequate manipulations Data collection insufficient; Analyses are incorrect or not competently conducted	Design is sufficient to answer question; Data competently collected; Reasonable attempts made to address issues of power; Analyses are reasonable for answering hypotheses and are competently conducted	Research design allows for adequate hypothesis testing and leads to additional insights; A model of data collection; Analyses lead to additional insights	
Contribution to Field	Marginal contribution to the field; Probably at best a conference paper	Clear contribution to the field; Possibly publishable in a journal	Clear and important contribution; Publication likely in one of the top journals in the field	

Internship Evaluation Form – Supervisor

I. Directions

1. Read each statement below and rate the importance of that item to the successful completion of this internship according to the following scale: 1 = Little Importance; 2 = Somewhat Important; 3 = Very Important.
2. For each statement below, circle the number which best corresponds to your evaluation of this intern's performance. If there has been no opportunity to observe a particular performance factor, circle 0 (Not Applicable).

PERFORMANCE STATEMENT

Scale:	0	1	2	3	4	5
	N/A	Unacceptable	Marginal	Meets	Exceeds	Outstanding
			Requirements	Requirements		

Importance

- | | | | | | | | | |
|-------|----|--|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| _____ | 1. | Arrives on time for daily or scheduled activities. | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| _____ | 2. | Completes assignments within designated time frame. | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| _____ | 3. | Plans and organizes own time effectively. | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| _____ | 4. | Performs tasks with minimal supervision. | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| _____ | 5. | Demonstrates initiative in approaching and carrying out assignments. | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| _____ | 6. | Makes effective use of available resources (e.g., staff, equipment, reference materials) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| _____ | 7. | Assumes a practical orientation to business realities. | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| _____ | 8. | Generates alternative approaches/solutions to problem solving. | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| _____ | 9. | Demonstrates technical competence in area of expertise. | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

- _____ 10. Produces professional quality work.
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 11. Clearly expresses technical or complex information to others outside his/her field of expertise.
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 12. Relates to others in a non-condescending manner (not a know-it-all).
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 13. Makes formal presentations in a well organized and professional manner.
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 14. Maintains good interpersonal relationships with co-workers.
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 15. Uses oral communication skills effectively.
0 1 2 3 4 5
- _____ 16. Uses written communication skills effectively.
0 1 2 3 4 5

II. Comments

1. How would you summarize this individual's performance strengths?

2. What suggestions do you have for improving this individual's professional skills?

Appendix C

Areas of Competence to be Developed by I/O Psychology Programs

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE AND SKILLS

1. Ethical, Legal, Diversity, and International Issues (covered across Personnel and Organizational psychology exams)
2. Fields of Psychology[†]
3. History and Systems of Psychology[†]
4. Professional Skills (Communication, Business/Research Development, Consulting, and Project-Management Skills)[†]
5. Research Methods***
6. Statistical Methods/Data Analysis***

CORE CONTENT

7. Attitude Theory, Measurement, and Change**
8. Career Development[†]
9. Criterion Theory and Development*
10. Groups and Teams**
11. Human Performance*
12. Individual Assessment*
13. Individual Differences*
14. Job Evaluation and Compensation*
15. Job/Task/Work Analysis, Competency Modeling, and Classification*
16. Judgment and Decision-Making[†]
17. Leadership and Management**
18. Occupational Health and Safety**
19. Organization Development**
20. Organization Theory**
21. Performance Appraisal/Management*
22. Personnel Recruitment, Selection, and Placement*
23. Training: Theory, Delivery, Program Design, and Evaluation**
24. Work Motivation**

NOTE. *Personnel Psychology; **Organizational Psychology; ***Research Methods/Statistics; †Not intended to be tapped by the comprehensive exam.

Society for Industrial and Organizational Psychology, Inc. (2016). *Guidelines for education and training in industrial-organizational psychology*. Bowling Green, OH: Author.